How Rwanda can reach more poor families with the same VUP budget

EICV7 evidence shows a large coverage gap. Poverty-informed district budgets, transparent household prioritisation, and community verification could more than double the number of poor households reached.

THE PROBLEM

84 in 100

poor households report no support from the five observed VUP components.

THE OPPORTUNITY

+138,000

additional poor households could be reached with poverty-based quotas at the same budget.

What the evidence says

16% of poor households report receiving an observed VUP component.

68-84% is the defensible range for poor households left uncovered after survey-admin reconciliation.

68% of reported recipient households are above the poverty line.

0.38 is the district correlation between poverty and coverage, showing weak geographic alignment.

Recommended decision

Use published district poverty rates to distribute available places. Within districts, use a leakage-free household priority score to create a shortlist. Make final decisions only after community verification, clear explanations, and an accessible appeals process.

A practical path from evidence to action

The score supports decisions. It does not replace people, programme rules, or rights.

1. **Measure**

   NISR updates poverty evidence and validates model performance.

2. **Allocate**

   MINALOC and LODA set poverty-informed district quotas.

3. **Prioritise**

   Districts create transparent preliminary household shortlists.

4. **Verify**

   Community review checks circumstances the data cannot observe.

5. **Learn**

   Appeals and monitoring reveal errors and guide the next allocation.

90-DAY PILOT

Weeks 1-3	Agree variables, safeguards, roles, and published rules.
Weeks 4-7	Test in two high-gap and two comparison districts.
Weeks 8-10	Run verification and an accessible appeals process.
Weeks 11-13	Compare reach, errors, processing time, and appeals.

National policy alignment

NST2 Goal 26	Reduce poverty and improve standards of living.
Social protection	Increase transfer coverage and adequacy and improve social-registry targeting.
Vision 2050	Advance inclusive development and a high standard of living for all Rwandans.

Safeguards

No automatic eligibility decisions. No household records in the public dashboard. Monitor subgroup outcomes, explain decisions, allow appeals, and revalidate as conditions change.